

Member ID: \_\_\_\_\_

Time: \_\_\_\_\_

Rank: \_\_\_\_\_



# BASIC OFFICE SYSTEMS AND PROCEDURES (220)

## NATIONAL 2025

### MULTIPLE CHOICE

25 Questions (2 points each) \_\_\_\_\_ (50 points)

### PRODUCTION

**Job 1:** News Release \_\_\_\_\_ (100 points)

**Job 2:** Letter \_\_\_\_\_ (100 points)

**Job 3:** Itinerary \_\_\_\_\_ (100 points)

**Job 4:** Report \_\_\_\_\_ (100 points)

**TOTAL POINTS** \_\_\_\_\_ (450 points)

**Test Time: 90 minutes**

### GENERAL GUIDELINES:

***Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:***

1. Member must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any. Failure to do so will result in disqualification.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

### EXAM GUIDELINES:

1. Ensure this test booklet contains Jobs 1-4.
2. Key all jobs according to the instructions given.
3. Correct all formatting, spelling or grammar errors. Use the formatting guide in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
4. Your name or initials should *not* appear on any work you submit. Use your Member ID in any occasion you would normally key your reference initials.
5. In the lower **right**-hand corner of ALL work submitted (unless otherwise specified), key your Member ID and job number.
6. If you complete the event before the end of the time allotted, notify the proctor. Time may be considered a factor in determining a winner when there is a tie score.

### PART ONE Instructions: Concept Knowledge

1. Open Google Chrome and navigate to [compete.bpa.org](https://compete.bpa.org).
2. Click on the appropriate Division (Secondary or Post-Secondary) Competitions button.
3. Enter your BPA Member ID (8-digits) and Password to access your test questions.
4. Answer all questions and submit your test.
5. Move on to Part Two.

### PART TWO Instructions: Production

Once you have completed all four jobs listed below, upload all competition materials (including project files, etc.) to the National BPA Pre-submit System at [presubmit.bpa.org](https://presubmit.bpa.org).

**BOS-Job1-MemberID.pdf**

**BOS-Job2-MemberID.pdf**

**BOS-Job3-MemberID.pdf**

**BOS-Job4-MemberID.pdf**

| PRODUCTION STANDARDS |            |
|----------------------|------------|
| 0 Errors             | 100 Points |
| 1 Error              | 90 Points  |
| 2 Errors             | 70 Points  |
| 3 Errors             | 50 Points  |
| 4+ Errors            | 0 Points   |

### Multiple Choice Questions

*Directions:* Identify the letter of the choice that best completes the statement or answers the question.

1. According to ARMA rules, how should names with prefixes (e.g., "Mc" or "Van") be filed in an alphabetical system?
  - A. Ignore the prefix
  - B. File based on the prefix
  - C. Place the prefix at the end
  - D. Alphabetize the prefix and the following word
2. What does the proofreading mark "sp" stand for?
  - A. Split the word
  - B. Spell the word out
  - C. Insert a space
  - D. Space too wide
3. If you encounter the proofreading mark " " what will you need to do?
  - A. Change the letter or number
  - B. Change the order of letter or number
  - C. Transpose letters or words
  - D. Transpose spacing
4. Which inventory method assumes that the cost of the most recently purchased items is the cost of goods sold first?
  - A. FIFO
  - B. LIFO
  - C. Weighted Average
  - D. Specific Identification
5. In inventory management, what does the term "dead stock" refer to?
  - A. Inventory that has been misplaced
  - B. Items with slow or no turnover
  - C. Overstocked items
  - D. Permanently damaged inventory
6. When organizing invoices chronologically, which date should be used as the primary sorting criteria?
  - A. Creation date
  - B. Last modified date
  - C. Received date
  - D. Expiration date

7. In a numerical filing system, what is the purpose of a secondary index?
  - A. To provide additional security
  - B. To aid in cross-referencing
  - C. To speed up retrieval
  - D. To minimize errors
  
8. What is the correct filing order of these street names?
  - A. 123 Adams, Adams Ave., North 5<sup>th</sup>, NE Main St.
  - B. Adams Ave., 123 Adams, NE Main St., North 5<sup>th</sup>
  - C. 123 Adams, Adams Ave., NE Main St., North 5<sup>th</sup>
  - D. None of the answers
  
9. What is the purpose of a perpetual inventory system?
  - A. To count inventory periodically
  - B. To track inventory levels continuously in real-time
  - C. To avoid using technology in inventory management
  - D. To only update inventory records annually
  
10. Jacob's annual salary is \$50,000, and his employer deducts 10% for federal taxes, 6.2% for social security and 1.45% for Medicare. What is the total dollar amount withheld annually for FICA taxes?
  - A. \$8,825
  - B. \$3,825
  - C. \$3,100
  - D. \$725
  
11. A meeting is scheduled in Los Angeles, CA at 11:00 a.m. What time is it in New York?
  - A. 2:00 p.m.
  - B. 12:00 p.m.
  - C. 10:00 a.m.
  - D. 9:00 a.m.
  
12. What does the Economic Order Quantity represent in inventory management?
  - A. The ideal order quantity that minimizes total inventory costs
  - B. The total value of all items in inventory
  - C. The maximum quantity a warehouse can hold
  - D. The minimum number of inventory items to be sold to meet sales quota
  
13. In MLA format, which words in a title should be capitalized?
  - A. Only the first and last words
  - B. All major words
  - C. Only nouns and verbs
  - D. Only the first word

14. How should a long quotation (more than four lines) be formatted in an MLA report?
  - A. Single spaced and indented
  - B. Double spaced and indented
  - C. Single spaced without indentation
  - D. Double space without indentation
15. Where is the header located on a page formatted in MLA style, and what information does it include?
  - A. Bottom right, author's name
  - B. Top left, author's name
  - C. Top right, author's name, and page number
  - D. Bottom left, page number
16. What term is commonly used for the subdivisions under main points in an outline?
  - A. Categories
  - B. Dividers
  - C. Classifications
  - D. Subheadings
17. In a traditional outline, which level is often designated by uppercase Roman numerals?
  - A. Level 1
  - B. Level 2
  - C. Level 3
  - D. Level 4
18. What purpose does indentation serve in an outline?
  - A. It signifies the end of a section
  - B. It creates a visually pleasing layout
  - C. It highlights main ideas
  - D. It separates different levels of detail
19. Which of the following elements is typically found in the header of a news release?
  - A. Contact information
  - B. Lead paragraph
  - C. Dateline
  - D. Main Body
20. What does the dateline in a news release include?
  - A. Contact person's name
  - B. Publication date
  - C. Location and date of release
  - D. Press release title

21. What is the purpose of boilerplate in a news release?
  - A. To provide background information about the company
  - B. To highlight key quotes
  - C. To list media contacts
  - D. To announce breaking news
  
22. If the price of a product increases from \$80 to \$100, what is the percentage increase?
  - A. 15%
  - B. 20%
  - C. 25%
  - D. 30%
  
23. What is the simple interest on a \$1,000 loan with an APR of 8% for 2 years?
  - A. \$160
  - B. \$80
  - C. \$16
  - D. \$8
  
24. If the cost of a product is \$40 and it is sold for \$60, what is the markup percentage?
  - A. 30%
  - B. 40%
  - C. 50%
  - D. 60%
  
25. What do the letters FICA represent?
  - A. Federal Investment Contributions Association
  - B. Federal Insurance Contributions Act
  - C. Federation of International Contributions Act
  - D. Financial Investment Contributions Act

### **Job 1: News Release**

Key the following as a News Release using the news release formatting in the Style and Reference Manual from Nancy Wells to be released on May 10, 20-- (use current year)

#### **Open Hand Columbus Partners with Dining Out For Life**

Open Hand Columbus and presenting sponsor CarTec are honored to announce that over \$127,000 was raised during the 29th annual Dining Out for Life benefit event, which was held on April 27, 2025. The annual event saw the city dine out at well-known restaurants from all over the Metro Columbus area to benefit the non-profit. One of the largest city-wide fundraisers of the year, proceeds from Dining Out for Life help Open Hand Columbus and its thousands of volunteers provide nearly 5,000 nutritious meals daily and support their neighbors battling chronic disease and disability to live healthier, more independent lives.

Dining Out for Life is an international event that occurs annually throughout 60 cities worldwide. While dining out for breakfast, lunch and dinner in Columbus, guests could choose from a list of over 80 participating restaurants. In return, the restaurants donated a portion of each customer's total bill to Open Hand Columbus. This year's restaurants included Columbus favorites, such as Saucy Rocco's, The General Delger, Local Five, Max Pint's and Pollo.

On September 29, Open Hand Columbus's annual benefit Party in the Kitchen will return for its 19th year. Hosted in The Stage Room at American WaterWorks, this formal fundraising event will engage guests with an elegant night of live and silent auctions, music and delicious bites and cocktails from some of Columbus's best restaurants, with all proceeds benefiting the organization.

For more information on Dining Out for Life and Open Hand Columbus, as well as events and volunteer opportunities, please visit [diningoutforoh.org](http://diningoutforoh.org) or connect via Facebook or Instagram.

### **Job 2: Letter**

Key the following as a Business Letter using the letter formatting in the Style and Reference Manual. Use 4562 Market St, St. Paul, MN 55105 for the recipient Ms. Olivia Sykes at Solvent Industries and use the current date and current year. Harvey Rosen, the Financial Services Manager is sending this letter. A copy of the letter should be sent to the Accounting Department.

I wanted to write you a letter to address a problem we have encountered with your order department on the last two occasions we have purchased from you. Both of our last two orders with your company were not completed in full. They were both missing one ream of paper, totaling 1,000 sheets of paper in all. While one oversight is acceptable, I am hoping this is not becoming a pattern.

I would like this situation to kindly be rectified by the two reams of paper being replaced and sent to my attention. I am including a copy of the recent packing slips and orders.

We have enjoyed doing business with your company over the years and look forward to this situation being addressed so we can move forward and continue to do so. Please contact me if you have any questions about this matter.

### **Job 3: Itinerary**

Key the following document as an Itinerary using the Style and Reference Manual for Harvey Rosen on May 19-21, 20 - - (Use current year)

Monday, 7:30 am, May 19, depart Dulles International Airport (IAD), United Airlines Flight 322 to Minneapolis, MN, nonstop

10:00 am. arrive at Minneapolis – St. Paul International Airport (MSP)

May 19 at 12:30 pm, luncheon with Bruce Wyatt, Soylent Industries, at Brasso, 7678 Cedar Ave, regarding new product launch

Tuesday, May 20 at 10 am, meeting with Sarah Bloss, Soylent Industries, the Hyatt Hotel, Conference Room 2, regarding new product launch budget

Product launch planning meeting on May 20 at 3:30 pm, Hyatt Hotel, Conference Room 1, with Bruce Wyatt

7:00 pm, dinner with Soylent Industries product launch committee regarding product launch presentation, May 20, Boludo, S. 4th St.

May 21, Wednesday, 7:00 am, depart Minneapolis, Minneapolis – St. Paul International Airport (MSP), Flight 589, United Airlines, nonstop

Arrive at Dulles International Airport (IAD), 10:00 am

#### **Job 4: Report**

Key the following as a report using the Style and Reference Manual as formatting guidelines. Harvey Rosen is sending the report to Julie Smith. Julie Smith is the HR manager for the business. Use today's date and current year.

##### **Companies Push Prices Higher, Protecting Profits**

Some of the world's biggest companies have said they do not plan to change course and will continue increasing prices or keep them at elevated levels for the foreseeable future. That strategy has cushioned corporate profits. And it could keep inflation robust, contributing to the very pressures used to justify surging prices.

##### **Rising Interest Rates**

As a result, some economists warn policymakers that the Federal Reserve may feel compelled to keep raising interest rates, or at least not lower them, increasing the likelihood and severity of an economic downturn.

##### **Solvent Counters Increased Costs**

John Houston, the company's chief financial officer, said in February that Solvent had raised its prices by enough to buffer further cost pressures in 2023. At the end of April, the company reported that it had raised the average price across its snacks and beverages by 16% in the first three months of the year. That added to a similar price increase in the fourth quarter of 2022 and increased its profit margin.

##### **The Producer and Consumer Price Indexes**

But those go-to rationales for elevating prices, he added, are now receding. The Producer Price Index, which measures the prices that businesses pay for goods and services before they are sold to consumers, reached a high of 11.7% last spring. That rate plunged to 2.3% for the 12 months through April.

Other corporations have found that fewer sales at higher prices have still helped them earn bigger profits, a dynamic that Mr. Stone of Pabor has coined "price over volume." Galaxy, Inc., which in addition to commanding a roughly 40% share of the global toothpaste market sells kitchen soap and other goods, had a standout first quarter. Its operating profit for the year through March rose 6% from a year earlier — the result of a 12% increase in prices even as volume declined by 2%.

The recent bonanza for corporate profits, however, may soon start to fizzle.